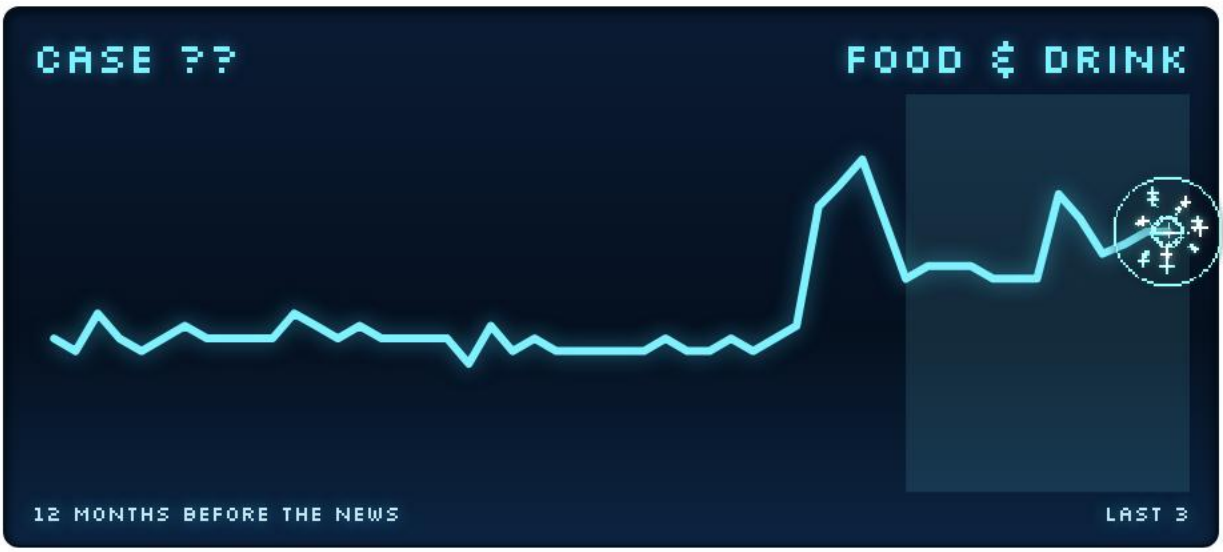
BRING_BACK.EXE

Can you see a comeback coming?

This is a year of people searching for a product, before the brand said it was coming back. Would you bring it back?



Bring it back

Leave it

Answer on the last slide.

Brands bring things back all the time

Fans ask for a discontinued snack, a lip gloss, a sneaker. Sometimes the brand listens. Some comebacks stay for good. Most don't.

My question: if fans are already searching for it before the brand says a word, does that comeback last?

I sourced 42 real US comebacks from 2014 to 2025 in food and drink, beauty and sportswear, flops included, and measured the 26 with enough search data.

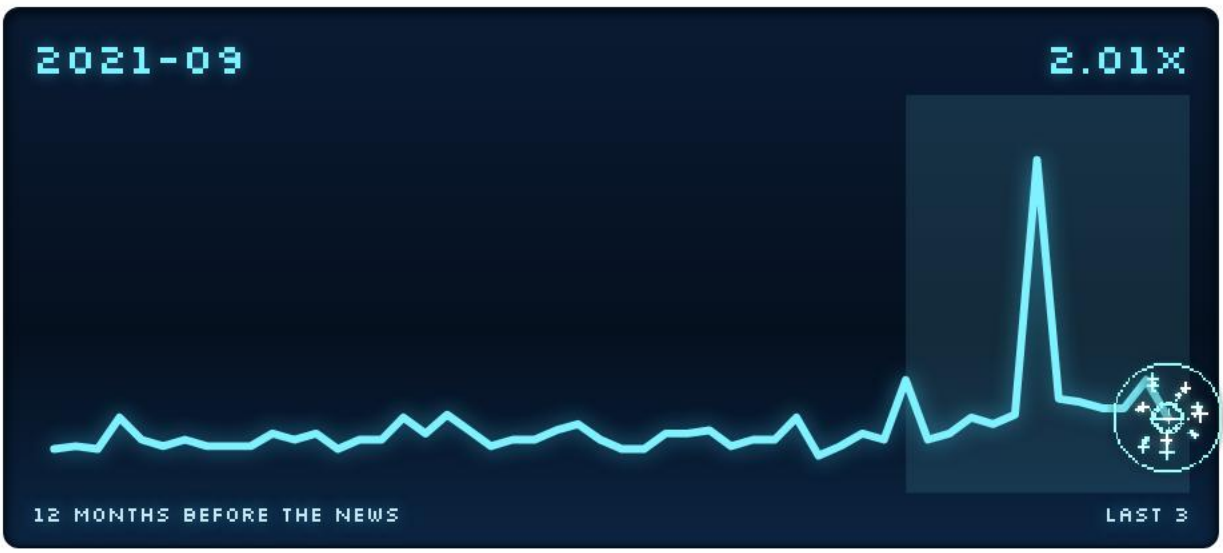
One number per comeback



1. Average searches in the last 3 months before the announcement, divided by the 9 months before that.
2. Divide by the same number for the brand, so a brand that's growing anyway doesn't count.
3. Set the cut-off on 2014 to 2020. Test it once on 2021 to 2023.

Rules written and dated before any data was pulled. "Lasted" means still on sale two years later.

Oreo Cakesters



Still on sale two years on. Back on US shelves in early 2022 as a permanent line; Oreo was still making it in 2026 (after a recipe change).

Her rule said	Called it
Bring it back	**Right**

Held out: the line was set without this case. Source: tastingtable.com

Search interest vs its brand, Google Trends, US. Attention, not sales.

Volcano Menu (Volcano Taco / Burrito)



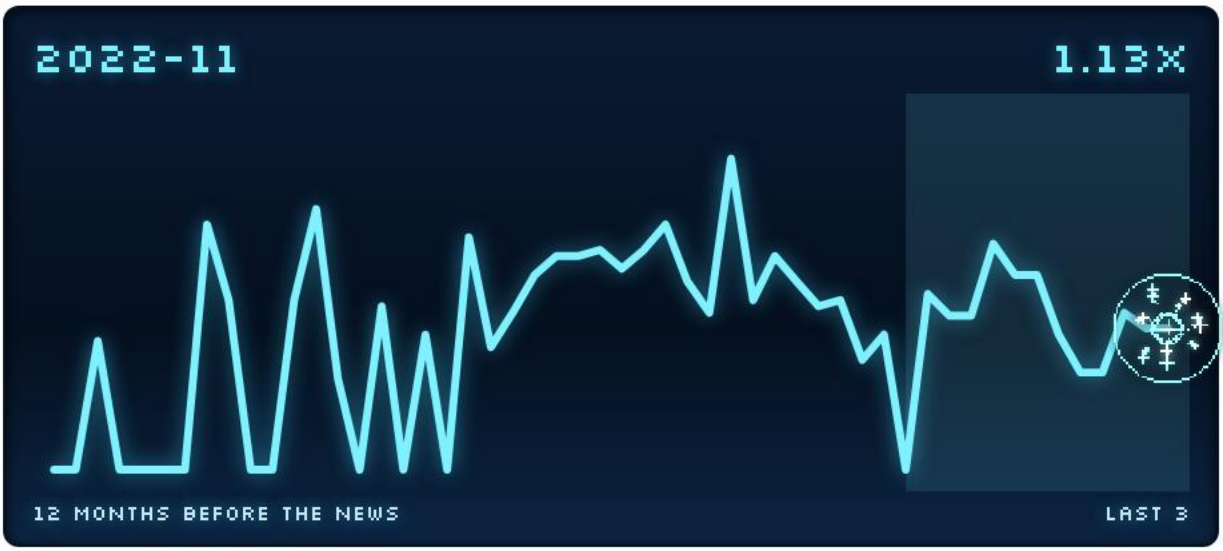
Gone again within two years. Sold as a limited-time summer 2023 menu from June 29; no further run was found before March 2025.

Her rule said	Called it
Bring it back	**Wrong**

Held out: the line was set without this case. Source: tacobell.com

Search interest vs its brand, Google Trends, US. Attention, not sales.

Mtn Dew Pitch Black



Only back for limited runs. After the limited January 2023 retail run, PepsiCo ran an eclipse sweepstakes in April 2024, which was not a sale. From Sept 2024 Pitch Black returned as a fountain-only drink at Speedway and 7-Eleven.

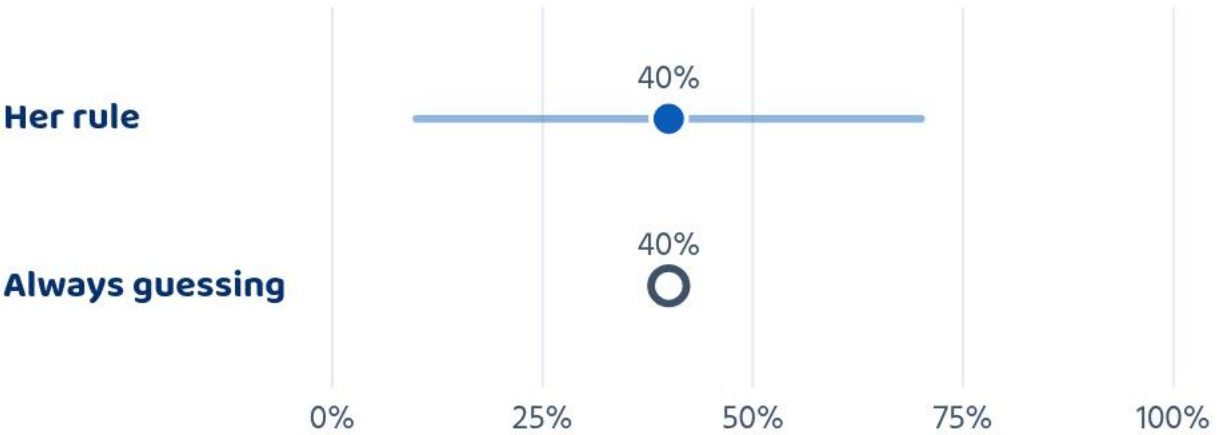
Her rule said	Called it
Bring it back	**Wrong**

Held out: the line was set without this case. Source: sporked.com

Search interest vs its brand, Google Trends, US. Attention, not sales.

The signal did no better than guessing

It called 4 of 10 held-out comebacks. So did always guessing.



Held-out hit rate with its 95% bootstrap range, n = 10. One case moves it 10 points, so this is directional.

SO_WHAT.TXT

What I'd tell a brand team

1. **Early buzz is normal, not a green light.** Search interest was already rising before 18 of 22 comebacks, including 8 of 10 of the ones that faded.
2. **Test whether demand holds.** A limited run or a few regions shows whether people come back after the first spike.
3. **Judge it after launch.** Watch what happens once the novelty wears off, not the noise before it.

The first point is exploratory: found after the test, so it is a lead to check, not a result.

BRING_BACK.EXE

Your turn

Call three comebacks blind against my rule, then read the whole study: every case, every source, and the 4 I've called for 2027.

Slide 1 was Mexican Pizza. Still on sale two years on.

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Start menu, then Comeback study. Study by Tahsin Anan, with research and build support.